

Stop doing repetitive work by hand

Three things I automated in Excel that I used to do manually — and what each one actually cost me before.

BY HAND

2 hrs

copy, paste, re-check, find the one row that broke

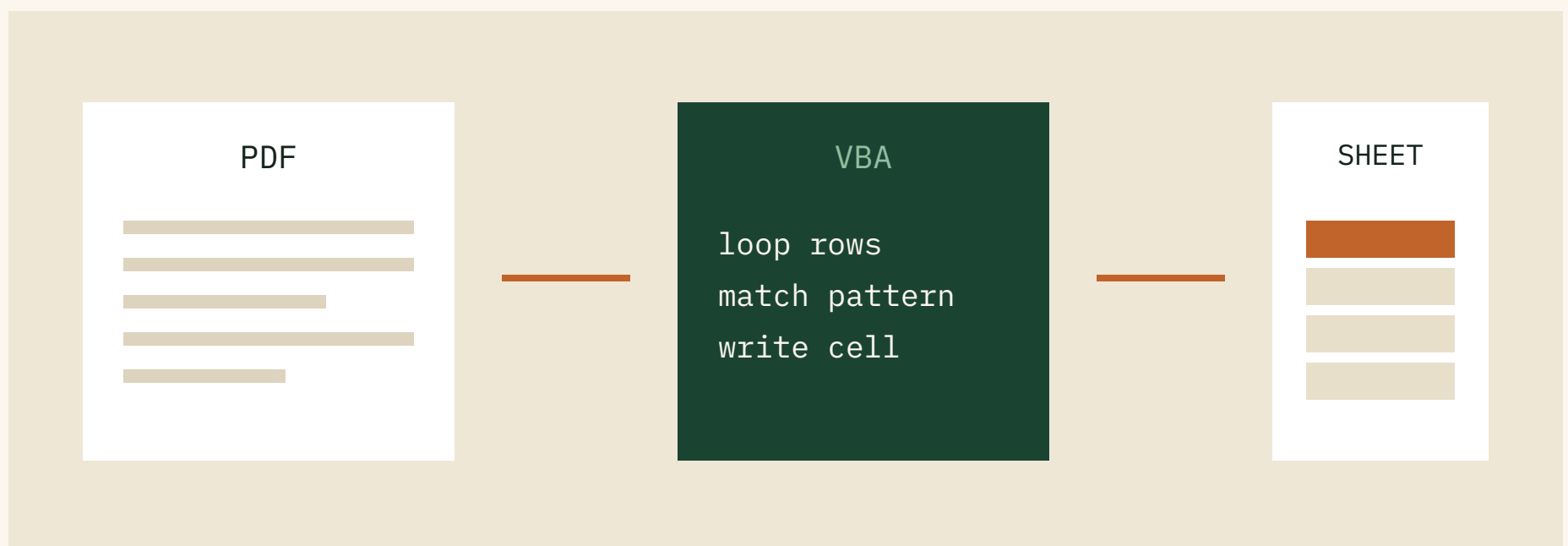
WITH A MACRO

2 min

same file, same output, run while the kettle boils

The table was always in there. Getting it out was the job.

Copy-pasting tables out of a PDF is slow, and worse, it fails quietly — one merged cell and the whole column shifts.



“The hours weren't in the reading. They were in the re-checking.”

Hundreds of unique codes, or one afternoon of typing.

Doing it by hand isn't just slow — you will eventually issue the same code twice and not find out for a month.

TYPED BY HAND

REF-0001

REF-0002

REF-0004

REF-0004
duplicate — missed

REF-0005

GENERATED

REF-7K2Q9

REF-M4XD1

REF-B8ZP6

REF-T3RW5

REF-J9HN2

400 rows · 1.2 seconds

THE TRADE-OFF

A generator is right until someone needs one code changed by hand. Leave a manual override — you will need it.

Four sources. Four ideas of what a date looks like.

The cleanup isn't hard. It's just long, and it comes back every single month.

BEFORE

12/03/2026	1.250,00	jakarta
Mar 12 2026	1250.00	JAKARTA
2026-03-12	Rp1.250	Jkt

AFTER · ONE MACRO

2026-03-12	1250.00	Jakarta
2026-03-12	1250.00	Jakarta

“A two-hour cleanup became two minutes — and stopped being a job anyone had to remember.”

You think Excel is

a spreadsheet.

With VBA it becomes

a lightweight automation engine you already own.

EXCEL

where the data already
lives

MACRO

the rule you only write
once

WORKFLOW

runs without
you

No new licence. No procurement. No dev team. The capability was sitting in the app you open every morning.

Automate the small thing. Keep the hours.

None of these were big projects. Each one started as a task I was tired of doing twice.

Structured PDF extraction

hours → minutes

Referral code generation

400 rows · 1.2s

Format normalisation

2 hrs → 2 min

What manual task could you automate today?